1 INFORMED CONSENT

The study in which you are asked to participate is designed to assess the mental health and resilience of university faculty and student mentors, measure how much they know about mental health, and to see what their attitudes are for seeking help for mental health. The study is being conducted by Mara Meinzer and Alina Thiele (M.Sc. and B.Sc students, respectively) under the supervision of Prof. Dr. Christian Pester (Associate Professor of Materials Science and Engineering at University of Delaware) and Prof. Dr. Sarah Schaefer (Junior Professor of Psychology the Technische Universität Braunschweig and the Leibniz Institute for Resilience Research). The study has been approved by the ethics committee of the Technische Universität Braunschweig.

PURPOSE: The purpose of the study is to examine the participants' mental health, resilience, and knowledge on mental health topics, as well as their attitudes toward seeking help for mental health issues.

DESCRIPTION: Participants will be asked questions on their mental health, their resilience, and their knowledge of mental health topics and disorders, their feelings toward people with mental health issues, attitudes about seeking help for mental health problems, and some demographic questions. When answering the questions, the aim is not to think about them as long and comprehensively as possible, but we are interested in your intuitive assessment. So please indicate what you think is most likely to apply to you. As a rule, there is no right or wrong answer to the questions.

PARTICIPATION: Your participation in the study is totally voluntary. You can refuse to participate in the study or discontinue your participation at any time without any consequences.

CONFIDENTIALITY: Your responses will remain confidential, and data will be reported in group form only.

DURATION: It will take 15 to 20 minutes to complete the survey.

RISKS: Although not anticipated, there may be some discomfort in answering some of the questions. You are not required to answer and can skip the question or end your participation.

BENEFITS: There will not be any direct benefits to the participants. However, findings from the study will contribute to our knowledge in this area of research and help us identify potential interventions to improve faculty and student mental health in academia.

CONTACT: If you have any questions about this study, please feel free to contact Prof. Dr. Pester at pester@udel.edu or Prof. Dr. Schaefer at sarah.schaefer@tu-braunschweig.de.

RESULTS: Results of the study can be obtained from http://sites.udel.edu/MHLiteracyStudy

I understand that I must be 18 years of age or older to participate in your study, have read and understand the consent document and agree to participate in your study.

- ○ Yes, I agree to participate and want to continue to the questionnaire.
- ○ No, I do not wish to participate

2 DEMOGRAPHICS

> **!** *Studies have related various personal parameters to mental well-being. These include, but are not limited to, socioeconomical background and status, demographic factors (e.g., age, race, gender, etc.), as well as professional position. Please answer the following questions about yourself.*

2.1 PERSONAL INFORMATION

What is your age?

_____

Are you a US citizen?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

Please specify your ethnicity (you may select more than one)

- ○ Caucasian
- ○ African American
- ○ LatinX
- ○ Asian
- ○ Native American
- ○ Native Alaskan/Hawaiian or Pacific Islander
- ○ Prefer not to Specify

What gender do you identify as?

- ○ Female
- ○ Male
- ○ Cis
- ○ Dyadic
- ○ Inter
- ○ Non-binary
- ○ Questioning
- ○ Trans
- ○ Prefer to self-identify: _____
- ○ Prefer not to answer

2.2 FAMILY

Do you have a spouse or partner? Yes ☐ No ☐

Do you have children? Yes ☐ No ☐

2.3 PROFESSIONAL POSITION

What is your position?

Primary research track (tenure track)

- ○ Assistant Professor
- ○ Associate Professor
- ○ Full Professor
- ○ Distinguished Professor

Instructional track (non-tenure track)

- ○ Lecturer
- ○ Instructor
- ○ Assistant Teaching Professor
- ○ Associate Teaching Professor
- ○ Teaching Professor
- ○ Assistant Research Professor
- ○ Associate Research Professor
- ○ Research Professor
- ○ Professor

Other _____

Are you tenured?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

Which department are you working in?

- ○ Biology
- ○ Chemistry & Biochemistry
- Engineering
  - ○ Aerospace Engineering
  - ○ Biomedical Engineering
  - ○ Computer Engineering
  - ○ Chemical Engineering
  - ○ Civil Engineering
  - ○ Electrical Engineering
  - ○ Environmental Engineering
  - ○ Nuclear Engineering
- ○ Materials Science
- ○ Mathematics
- ○ Physics
- ○ Other _____

What is the ranking of your department's graduate program?
If you are unsure, please use rankings provided by Times Higher Education at https://www.timeshighereducation.com/world-university-rankings/2024/world-ranking

- ○ 1-10
- ○ 11-20
- ○ 21-30
- ○ 31-40

What is your major of study?

- ○ Biology
- ○ Chemistry & Biochemistry
- Engineering
  - ○ Aerospace Engineering
  - ○ Biomedical Engineering
  - ○ Computer Engineering
  - ○ Chemical Engineering
  - ○ Civil Engineering
  - ○ Electrical Engineering
  - ○ Environmental Engineering
  - ○ Nuclear Engineering
- ○ Materials Science
- ○ Mathematics
- ○ Physics
- ○ Other _____

In which country did you obtain your highest degree?

- ○ USA
- ○ Other _____

3 TEACHING, MENTORING, AND STUDENT INTERACTION

> **!** Considering the established importance of the advisor/advisee relationship for faculty and graduate students, alike, we are interested in examining this interface.

What is the typical teaching load each year in your primary unit?

Number of undergraduate courses? _____

Number of graduate courses? _____

Number of student contact hours per week? _____

(Not covered by formal courses)

For how many of each of the following types of individuals (including 0) do you currently serve as *official* advisor?

Undergraduates _____

MA students _____

PhD students _____

Post-docs _____

Residents/ fellows _____

Junior faculty _____

***On average*, how many hours per month do you spend on *informal* mentoring activities (e.g. advising, counseling, advocating for students or junior faculty who are not your advisees)?**

_____

How many students have you referred to counseling services within the last three years?

_____

4 MENTAL HEALTH / WELL-BEING

> **!** Many stressors exist for faculty members and students in the academic environment. Personal stress and anxiety can alternate the behavior of individuals and their interactions with others, inherently connecting mental health and well-being with the academic environment. With this in mind, we would like to ask you the following questions related to your well-being and mental health.

4.1 WELL-BEING INDEX (WHO-5)

Please respond to each item by marking <u>one box per row</u> regarding how you felt in the last two weeks

		All of the time	*Most of the time*	*More than half the time*	*Less than half the time*	*Some of the time*	*At no time*
WHO1	I have felt cheerful in good spirits.	○	○	○	○	○	○
WHO2	I have felt calm and relaxed.	○	○	○	○	○	○
WHO3	I have felt active and vigorous.	○	○	○	○	○	○
WHO4	I woke up feeling fresh and rested.	○	○	○	○	○	○
WHO5	My daily life has been filled with things that interest me.	○	○	○	○	○	○

4.2 GENEREAL HEALTH QUESTIONNAIRE (GHQ-12)

We would like to know if you have had any medical complaints and how your health has been in general, over the past few weeks. Please answer all the questions on the following pages simply by checking the answer which you think most nearly applies to you. Remember that we want to know about present and recent complaints, not those that you had in the past. It is important that you try to answer all the questions. Thank you very much for your cooperation.

Have you recently...

	Not at all	*Not more than usual*	*Rather more than usual*	*Much more than usual*
Been able to concentrate on what you're doing?	○	○	○	○
Lost much sleep over worry?	○	○	○	○
Felt you were playing a useful part in things?	○	○	○	○
Felt capable of making decisions about things?	○	○	○	○
Felt constantly under strain?	○	○	○	○
Felt you couldn't overcome your difficulties?	○	○	○	○
Been able to enjoy your normal day-to-day activities?	○	○	○	○
Been able to face up to your problems?	○	○	○	○
Been feeling unhappy and depressed?	○	○	○	○
Been losing confidence in yourself?	○	○	○	○
Been thinking of yourself as a worthless person?	○	○	○	○
Been feeling reasonably happy, all things considered?	○	○	○	○

4.3 PATIENT HEALTH QUESTIONNAIRE FOR ANXIETY AND DEPRESSION (PHQ-4)

Over the last two weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems?

	Not at all	*Several days*	*More than half the days*	*Nearly every day*
Feeling nervous, anxious or on edge	○	○	○	○
Not being able to stop or control worrying	○	○	○	○
Worrying too much about different things	○	○	○	○
Little interest or pleasure in doing things	○	○	○	○

4.4 ANXIETY SYMPTOMS (GAD-7)

Over the last two weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems?

	Not at all	*Several days*	*More than half the days*	*Nearly every day*
Feeling nervous, anxious or on edge	○	○	○	○
Not being able to stop or control worrying	○	○	○	○
Worrying too much about different things	○	○	○	○
Trouble relaxing	○	○	○	○
Being so restless that it is hard to sit still	○	○	○	○
Becoming easily annoyed or irritable	○	○	○	○
Feeling afraid as if something awful might happen	○	○	○	○

5 RESILIENCE / PSYCHOSOCIAL RESOURCES

! How one responds to stressors and interactions with peers/students in distress can have consequences regarding one's mental well-being. Resilience is the ability to cope with stressors and related to various factors, including one's level of social support. Please answer the following questions related to resilience and psychosocial resources in your life.

5.1 BRIEF PERCEIVED SOCIAL SUPPORT QUESTIONNAIRE (F-SOZU K-6)

For the following statements, please indicate how strongly you agree or disagree with each statement.

	Not true at all				*Very true*
I experience a lot of understanding and security from others.	○	○	○	○	○
I know a very close person whose help I can always count on.	○	○	○	○	○
If necessary, I can easily borrow something I might need from neighbors or friends.	○	○	○	○	○
I know several people with whom I like to do things.	○	○	○	○	○
When I am sick, I can without hesitation ask friends and family to take care of important matters for me.	○	○	○	○	○
If I am down, I know to whom I can go without hesitation.	○	○	○	○	○

5.2 BRIEF RESILIENCE SCALE (BRS)

Please respond to each item by marking <u>one box per row</u>

		Strongly disagree	*disagree*	*neutral*	*agree*	*Strongly agree*
BR S1	I tend to bounce back quickly after hard times.	○	○	○	○	○
BR S2	I have a hard time making it through stressful events.	○	○	○	○	○
BR S3	It does not take me long to recover form a stressful event.	○	○	○	○	○
BR S4	It is hard for me to snap back when something bad happens.	○	○	○	○	○
BR S5	I usually come through difficult times with little trouble.	○	○	○	○	○
BR S6	I tend to take a long time to get over set-back in my life.	○	○	○	○	○

5.3 COGNITIVE EMOTIONAL REGULATION (CERQ-SHORT)

Please respond to each item by marking <u>one box per row</u>

	Always never				*Almost Always*
I think that I have to accept that this has happened	○	○	○	○	○
I often think about how I feel about what I have experienced	○	○	○	○	○
I think I can learn something from the situation	○	○	○	○	○
I feel that I am the one who is responsible for what has happened	○	○	○	○	○
I think that I have to accept the situation	○	○	○	○	○
I am preoccupied with what I think and feel about what I have experienced	○	○	○	○	○
I think of pleasant things that have nothing to do with it	○	○	○	○	○
I think that I can become a stronger person as a result of what has happened	○	○	○	○	○

I keep thinking about how terrible it is what I have experienced	○	○	○	○	○
I feel that others are responsible for what happened	○	○	○	○	○
I think of something nice instead of what happened	○	○	○	○	○
I think about how to change the situation	○	○	○	○	○
I think that it hasn't been too bad compared to other things	○	○	○	○	○
I think that basically the cause must lie within myself	○	○	○	○	○
I think about a plan of what I can do best	○	○	○	○	○
I tell myself that there are worse things in life	○	○	○	○	○
I continually think how horrible the situation has been	○	○	○	○	○
I feel that basically the cause lies with others	○	○	○	○	○

6 MENTAL HEALTH LITERACY

> **!** Studies have shown correlations between an individual's mental health with their knowledge on the topic, i.e., their mental health literacy. We would like to ask you to respond to the following questions so we can learn how much you know about the topic of mental health.

6.1 MENTAL HEALTH LITERACY QUESTIONNAIRE-SHORT VERSION FOR ADULTS (MHLQ-SVA)

This questionnaire is designed to understand what people think about mental health problems. The questions focus on aspects such as: what mental health problems you have heard of and how you feel about them, where to go to get help, how you deal with these problems.

	Strongly disagree	*disagree*	*Neither agree nor disagree*	*agree*	*Strongly agree*
Mental disorders affect people's thoughts.	○	○	○	○	○
A person with schizophrenia may see and hear things that nobody else sees and hears.	○	○	○	○	○
One of the symptoms of depression is the loss of interest or pleasure in most things.	○	○	○	○	○
Highly stressful situations may cause mental disorders.	○	○	○	○	○
Changes in brain function may lead to the onset of mental disorders.	○	○	○	○	○
The symptom's length is one of the important criteria for the diagnosis of a mental disorder.	○	○	○	○	○
Only adults have mental disorders.	○	○	○	○	○
Mental disorders don't affect people's feelings.	○	○	○	○	○
Mental disorders don't affect people's behaviors.	○	○	○	○	○
If I had a mental disorder I would seek a psychologist's help.	○	○	○	○	○

If someone close to me had a mental disorder, I would encourage her/him to see a psychiatrist.	○	○	○	○	○
If I had a mental disorder I would seek a psychiatrist's help.	○	○	○	○	○
Sleeping well contributes to good mental health.	○	○	○	○	○
A balanced diet contributes to good mental health.	○	○	○	○	○
Physical exercise contributes to good mental health.	○	○	○	○	○
Doing something enjoyable contributes to a good mental health.	○	○	○	○	○

6.2 MENTAL HEALTH LITERACY SCALE (MHLS)

The purpose of these questions is to gain an understanding of your knowledge of various aspects to do with mental health. When responding, we are interested in your degree of knowledge.

		Very Unlikely	*Unlikely*	*Likely*	*Very Likely*
1	If someone became extremely nervous or anxious in one or more situations with other people (e.g., a party) or performance situations (e.g., presenting at a meeting) in which they were afraid of being evaluated by others and that they would act in a way that was humiliating or feel embarrassed, then to what extent do you think it is likely they have **Social Phobia**	○	○	○	○
2	If someone experienced excessive worry about a number of events or activities where this level of concern was not warranted, had difficulty controlling this worry and had physical symptoms such as having tense muscles and feeling fatigued then to what extent do you think it is likely they have **Generalised Anxiety Disorder**	○	○	○	○
3	If someone experienced a low mood for two or more weeks, had a loss of pleasure or interest in their normal activities and experienced changes in their appetite and sleep then to what extent do you think it is likely they have **Major Depressive Disorder**	○	○	○	○

4	To what extent do you think it is likely that **Personality Disorders** are a category of mental illness	○	○	○	○
5	To what extent do you think it is likely that **Dysthymia** is a disorder	○	○	○	○
6	To what extent do you think it is likely that the diagnosis of **Agoraphobia** includes anxiety about situations where escape may be difficult or embarrassing	○	○	○	○
7	To what extent do you think it is likely that the diagnosis of **Bipolar Disorder** includes experiencing periods of elevated (i.e., high) and periods of depressed (i.e., low) mood	○	○	○	○
8	To what extent do you think it is likely that the diagnosis of **Drug Dependence** includes physical and psychological tolerance of the drug (i.e., require more of the drug to get the same effect)	○	○	○	○
9	To what extent do you think it is likely that in general in the U.S., **women are MORE likely to experience a mental illness of any kind compared to men**	○	○	○	○
10	To what extent do you think it is likely that in general, in the U.S.**, men are MORE likely to experience an anxiety disorder compared to women**	○	○	○	○
11	To what extent do you think it is likely that **Cognitive Behaviour Therapy (CBT)** is a therapy based on challenging negative thoughts and increasing helpful behaviours	○	○	○	○
12	Mental health professionals are bound by confidentiality; however there are certain conditions under which this does not apply. To what extent do you think it is likely that the following is a condition that would allow a mental health professional to **break confidentiality**: *If you are at immediate risk of harm to yourself or others*	○	○	○	○
13	Mental health professionals are bound by confidentiality; however there are certain conditions under which this does not apply. To what extent do you think it is likely that the following is a condition that would allow a mental health professional to **break confidentiality**: *if your problem is not life-threatening and they want to assist others to better support you*	○	○	○	○

14	To what extent do you think it would be helpful for someone to **improve their quality of sleep** if they were having difficulties managing their emotions (e.g., becoming very anxious or depressed)	○	○	○	○
15	To what extent do you think it would be helpful for someone to **avoid all activities or situations that made them feel anxious** if they were having difficulties managing their emotions	○	○	○	○

Please indicate to what extent you agree with the following statements:

		Strongly Disagree	*Disagree*	*Neither agree nor disagree*	*Agree*	*Strongly Agree*
16	I am confident that I know where to seek information about mental illness	○	○	○	○	○
17	I am confident using the computer or telephone to seek information about mental illness	○	○	○	○	○
18	I am confident attending face to face appointments to seek information about mental illness (e.g., seeing the GP)	○	○	○	○	○
19	I am confident I have access to resources (e.g., GP, internet, friends) that I can use to seek information about mental illness	○	○	○	○	○

Please indicate to what extent you agree with the following statements:

		Strongly Disagree	*Disagree*	*Neither agree nor disagree*	*Agree*	*Strongly Agree*
20	People with a mental illness could snap out if it if they wanted	○	○	○	○	○
21	A mental illness is a sign of personal weakness	○	○	○	○	○
22	A mental illness is not a real medical illness	○	○	○	○	○
23	People with a mental illness are dangerous	○	○	○	○	○

Please indicate to what extent you agree with the following statements:

		Definitely unwilling	*Probably unwilling*	*Neither unwilling or willing*	*Probably willing*	*Definitely willing*
24	How willing would you be to move next door to someone with a mental illness?	○	○	○	○	○
25	How willing would you be to make friends with someone with a mental illness?	○	○	○	○	○
26	How willing would you be to have someone with a mental illness marry into your family?	○	○	○	○	○
27	How willing would you be to employ someone if you knew they had a mental illness?	○	○	○	○	○

Please indicate if you used Google (or other search engines or resources) to provide your answers. Please answer truthfully so we can assess the quality of the responses above.

☐ Yes, other resources were used ☐ No extra resources were used

6.3 MENTAL HELP SEEKING ATTITUDE SCALE (MHSAS)

> **!** In the following, we are interested in learning how you perceive the idea of seeking professional help for a mental well-being concern.

For the purposes of this survey, “mental health professionals” include psychologists, psychiatrists, clinical social workers, and counselors. Likewise, “mental health concerns” include issues ranging from personal difficulties (e.g., loss of a loved one) to mental illness (e.g., anxiety, depression).

Please check the circle that best represents your opinion. For example, if you feel that your seeking help would be extremely useless, you would check the circle closest to "useless." If you are undecided, you would check the "0" circle. If you feel that your seeking help would be slightly useful, you would check the "1" circle that is closer to "useful."

If I had a mental health concern, seeking help from a mental health professional would be...

	3	2	1	0	1	2	3	
Useless	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	Useful
Important	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	Unimportant
Unhealthy	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	Healthy
Ineffective	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	Effective
Good	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	Bad
Healing	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	Hurting
Disempowering	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	Empowering
Satisfying	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	Unsatisfying
Desirable	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	Undesirable

7 INSTITUTION / DEPARTMENT CULTURE

> **!** Just as social factors can impact an individual's mental well-being, so can their work environment. Please answer the following questions, which interrogate your views on, and relationship with, your own department/unit as well as your perceived support through professional mentor(s).

7.1 DEPARTMENT CLIMATE

Please rate the climate of your unit(s)/department(s) on the following continuum by circling/underlining the appropriate number.

Friendly	○	○	○	○	○	Hostile
Racist	○	○	○	○	○	Non-racist
Homogeneous	○	○	○	○	○	Diverse
Disrespectful	○	○	○	○	○	Respectful
Collegial	○	○	○	○	○	Contentious
Non-sexist	○	○	○	○	○	Sexist
Collaborative	○	○	○	○	○	Individualistic
Cooperative	○	○	○	○	○	Competitive
Homophobic	○	○	○	○	○	Non-Homophobic
Not supportive	○	○	○	○	○	Supportive

Please indicate your level of agreement with each of the following statements concerning conditions in your unit(s)/department(s), and your relationships with your unit/department colleagues by *checking the appropriate box*.

	Strongly Disagree	*Tend to Disagree*	*Neutral*	*Tend to agree*	*Strongly Agree*	*Not applicable*
My research interests are valued by my colleagues.	○	○	○	○	○	○
I feel pressured to change my research agenda in order to fit in.	○	○	○	○	○	○
I feel/felt pressured to change my research agenda to make tenure/be promoted.	○	○	○	○	○	○
I am comfortable asking questions about performance expectations.	○	○	○	○	○	○
I am/ was reluctant to bring up issues that concern me for fear that it will/would affect my promotion/ tenure.	○	○	○	○	○	○
My colleagues expect me to represent "the point of view" of my gender.	○	○	○	○	○	○
My colleagues expect me to represent "the point of view" of my race/ethnicity.	○	○	○	○	○	○
My colleagues have lower expectations of me than of other faculty.	○	○	○	○	○	○
I constantly fell under scrutiny by my colleagues.	○	○	○	○	○	○
I have/had to work harder than I believe my colleagues do, in order to be/have been perceived as a legitimate scholar.	○	○	○	○	○	○
There are many unwritten rules concerning how one is expected to interact with unit colleagues.	○	○	○	○	○	○
Others seem to find it easier than I do to "fit in".	○	○	○	○	○	○

For each item, please *check the box* that best corresponds to how much influence you feel you have over the following matters in your unit(s)/department(s):

	Really no influence	*Minor influence*	*Some influence*	*Substantial influence*	*Tremendous influence*	*not applicable*
Unit curriculum decisions	○	○	○	○	○	○
Size of salary increases I receive	○	○	○	○	○	○
Obtaining money for travel to professional meetings	○	○	○	○	○	○
Securing the facilities or equipment I need for my research	○	○	○	○	○	○
Selecting new graduate students or residents/fellows	○	○	○	○	○	○
Selecting new faculty members to be hired	○	○	○	○	○	○
Determining who gets tenure	○	○	○	○	○	○
Selecting the next unit head	○	○	○	○	○	○
Affecting the overall unit climate/culture	○	○	○	○	○	○

7.2 MENTORSHIP

Is there anyone whom you currently regard as a mentor – someone who gives you advice and counsel on career issues and/or sponsors or advocates for you?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

In the chart below please indicate in the space provided how many male and female mentors you have and the kinds of support/advice they provide, according to their institutional affiliation category. Please answer separately for male and female mentors, as appropriate, and check all that apply. If you feel this is not applicable to you, please leave blank and check here: ○

My mentor(s).....	**Male mentors** No. of mentors (m) *N* = _____				**Female mentors** No. of mentors (f) *N* = _____			
	same unit *(all that apply)*	***different unit*** *(all that apply)*	***At other institution*** *(all that apply)*	***Outside academia*** *(all that apply)*	***same unit*** *(all that apply)*	***different unit*** *(all that apply)*	***At other institution*** *(all that apply)*	***Outside academia*** *(all that apply)*
Serves as a role model	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Promotes my career through networking	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Advises about preparation for advancement (e.g. promotion/tenure, leadership positions)	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Advises about getting my work published	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Advises about department politics	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Advises about obtaining the resources I need	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Advocates for me	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Advises about balancing work and family	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Other:	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○